

DESIGN THINKING: A PRIMER

Multiple Choice Question Paper

Total Questions: 100	Total Marks: 100
Time Allowed: 2 Hours	Each Question: 1 Mark

Instructions: Each question carries one mark. Choose the single best answer (A, B, C or D) for each question. There is no negative marking.

- Design Thinking is best described as a:
(A) Purely technical engineering discipline
(B) Human-centred approach to innovation and problem solving
(C) Financial accounting technique
(D) Random trial-and-error method
- Which organisation is most closely associated with popularising Design Thinking?
(A) OPEC
(B) WHO
(C) NASA
(D) IDEO
- Who is the author often credited with bringing Design Thinking to business through IDEO?
(A) Tim Brown
(B) Peter Drucker
(C) Bill Gates
(D) Steve Jobs
- The d.school that teaches Design Thinking is part of which university?
(A) Harvard
(B) Stanford
(C) MIT
(D) Oxford
- At the core of Design Thinking is empathy for the:
(A) Investor
(B) End user / customer
(C) Government
(D) Competitor
- The classic five-stage Design Thinking model begins with which stage?
(A) Empathize
(B) Test
(C) Prototype
(D) Ideate
- Which is the correct order of the five stages of Design Thinking?
(A) Ideate, Empathize, Define, Test, Prototype
(B) Empathize, Define, Ideate, Prototype, Test
(C) Define, Empathize, Ideate, Test, Prototype
(D) Prototype, Test, Ideate, Define, Empathize
- The three overlapping lenses of Design Thinking are desirability, feasibility, and:
(A) Viability
(B) Variability
(C) Visibility

(D) Volatility

9. 'Desirability' in Design Thinking primarily refers to what is:

- (A) Technically possible
- (B) Meaningful and useful to people
- (C) Financially sustainable
- (D) Legally permitted

10. 'Feasibility' refers to what is:

- (A) Profitable
- (B) Aesthetically pleasing
- (C) Desirable to users
- (D) Technically and organisationally possible

11. 'Viability' refers to what is:

- (A) Financially and strategically sustainable
- (B) Emotionally appealing
- (C) Easy to prototype
- (D) Technically possible

12. The main goal of the Empathize stage is to:

- (A) Write marketing copy
- (B) Calculate the budget
- (C) Understand users' needs, emotions and motivations
- (D) Build the final product

13. Which is a primary method used during the Empathize stage?

- (A) Patent filing
- (B) User observation and interviews
- (C) Mass production
- (D) Stock analysis

14. An 'empathy map' typically captures what the user says, thinks, does and:

- (A) Sells
- (B) Owns
- (C) Feels
- (D) Buys

15. A fictional character representing a user segment is called a:

- (A) Avatar bot
- (B) Persona
- (C) Prototype
- (D) Stakeholder

16. A customer journey map is used to visualise the user's:

- (A) Tax records
- (B) Bank balance
- (C) Genetic profile
- (D) Experience and touchpoints over time

17. The Define stage is mainly about:

- (A) Framing a clear, actionable problem statement
- (B) Selling the product
- (C) Mass manufacturing
- (D) Generating many ideas

18. A well-framed problem statement in Design Thinking is also known as a:

- (A) Point of View (POV) statement

- (B) Press release
- (C) Mission statement
- (D) Profit statement

19. Which phrase is commonly used to reframe problems as opportunities for ideation?

- (A) When Could They
- (B) Why Not Now
- (C) How Might We
- (D) What If Only

20. A good problem statement should be:

- (A) Broad and vague
- (B) Human-centred and not prescribe a solution
- (C) Focused only on technology
- (D) About the company's revenue

21. The Ideate stage focuses on:

- (A) Narrowing to one idea immediately
- (B) Testing prototypes
- (C) Conducting interviews
- (D) Generating a large quantity of diverse ideas

22. Brainstorming works best when participants initially aim for:

- (A) Quality over quantity
- (B) Criticism of every idea
- (C) Silence
- (D) Quantity of ideas and deferred judgment

23. A key rule of brainstorming is to:

- (A) Defer judgment and build on others' ideas
- (B) Stop at one idea
- (C) Allow only the manager to speak
- (D) Judge ideas immediately

24. 'Going for quantity' during ideation helps because:

- (A) It impresses investors
- (B) It reduces the need for testing
- (C) More ideas guarantee lower cost
- (D) A larger pool increases chances of novel solutions

25. SCAMPER is a technique used for:

- (A) User testing
- (B) Budgeting
- (C) Stimulating creative ideas
- (D) Market sizing

26. In SCAMPER, the 'S' commonly stands for:

- (A) Substitute
- (B) Standardise
- (C) Sell
- (D) Simplify

27. The 'C' in SCAMPER stands for:

- (A) Calculate
- (B) Compete
- (C) Combine
- (D) Copy

- 28.** Mind mapping is primarily a tool for:
- (A) Organising and generating ideas visually
 - (B) Inventory control
 - (C) Financial forecasting
 - (D) Code compilation
- 29.** Divergent thinking is about:
- (A) Following strict rules
 - (B) Expanding and generating many possibilities
 - (C) Selecting the single best option
 - (D) Cutting costs
- 30.** Convergent thinking is about:
- (A) Generating endless options
 - (B) Narrowing down and selecting the best ideas
 - (C) Avoiding decisions
 - (D) Ignoring constraints
- 31.** The Prototype stage aims to:
- (A) Conduct payroll
 - (B) Finalise mass production
 - (C) Replace the testing stage
 - (D) Build quick, inexpensive representations of ideas to learn
- 32.** A 'low-fidelity' prototype is typically:
- (A) A fully functional product
 - (B) A legal contract
 - (C) A finished mobile app
 - (D) Rough and inexpensive, like a paper sketch
- 33.** The main purpose of prototyping is to:
- (A) Impress shareholders
 - (B) Learn quickly and fail cheaply
 - (C) Avoid talking to users
 - (D) Skip the testing phase
- 34.** The Test stage is used to:
- (A) Gather user feedback and refine the solution
 - (B) Stop the project
 - (C) Launch the final product to the entire market
 - (D) Fire underperforming staff
- 35.** Design Thinking is generally considered a process that is:
- (A) Iterative and non-linear
 - (B) Done only once
 - (C) Strictly linear and one-directional
 - (D) Independent of users
- 36.** 'Iteration' in Design Thinking means:
- (A) Repeating and refining steps based on learning
 - (B) Avoiding feedback
 - (C) Copying competitors
 - (D) Doing the project once perfectly
- 37.** The Double Diamond model was popularised by the:
- (A) United Nations
 - (B) British Design Council

- (C) World Bank
- (D) Stanford d.school

38. The Double Diamond model alternates between divergent and ____ thinking.

- (A) random
- (B) negative
- (C) convergent
- (D) linear

39. The first diamond of the Double Diamond focuses on:

- (A) Finding the right problem
- (B) Building the solution
- (C) Manufacturing
- (D) Marketing

40. The second diamond of the Double Diamond focuses on:

- (A) Filing patents
- (B) Developing and delivering the right solution
- (C) Hiring staff
- (D) Defining the problem

41. 'Human-centred design' places which group at the centre of the process?

- (A) Regulators
- (B) People who will use the solution
- (C) Shareholders
- (D) Suppliers

42. Which mindset is essential to Design Thinking?

- (A) Avoiding users
- (B) Bias towards action and experimentation
- (C) Fear of failure
- (D) Working in isolation

43. A 'bias towards action' encourages designers to:

- (A) Delay decisions indefinitely
- (B) Make and test ideas rather than only discuss them
- (C) Avoid prototypes
- (D) Plan endlessly without acting

44. Storytelling in Design Thinking is used to:

- (A) Hide failures
- (B) Confuse stakeholders
- (C) Replace research
- (D) Communicate insights and ideas persuasively

45. Reframing a problem helps a team to:

- (A) See the challenge from new perspectives
- (B) Lock into the first solution
- (C) Reduce empathy
- (D) Avoid creativity

46. 'Beginner's mind' (or beginner's mindset) encourages designers to:

- (A) Ignore the user
- (B) Assume they know everything
- (C) Rely only on experts
- (D) Approach problems with curiosity and without assumptions

47. Observing users in their natural environment is sometimes called:

- (A) Auditing
- (B) Cold calling
- (C) Mass surveying only
- (D) Contextual inquiry / ethnographic observation

48. Open-ended interview questions are preferred because they:

- (A) Encourage rich, detailed responses
- (B) Save the most money
- (C) Yield yes/no answers
- (D) Avoid talking to users

49. A 'leading question' in user research should generally be:

- (A) Used to sell products
- (B) Encouraged
- (C) Avoided because it biases answers
- (D) Used to confuse users

50. Latent needs are needs that users:

- (A) Have but may not be able to articulate
- (B) Never actually have
- (C) Only mention in surveys
- (D) State clearly and loudly

51. Synthesis in Design Thinking refers to:

- (A) Ignoring data
- (B) Making sense of research to find patterns and insights
- (C) Selling the product
- (D) Building the product

52. An 'insight' is best described as a:

- (A) Non-obvious realisation that guides design
- (B) Random guess
- (C) Sales figure
- (D) Raw data point

53. Affinity mapping (clustering sticky notes) is used to:

- (A) Calculate profit
- (B) Recruit staff
- (C) Test prototypes
- (D) Group related observations to reveal themes

54. 'Fail fast, fail cheap' encourages teams to:

- (A) Avoid all risk
- (B) Never prototype
- (C) Hide mistakes
- (D) Learn early from inexpensive experiments

55. Which of the following is NOT one of the five classic stages?

- (A) Test
- (B) Empathize
- (C) Monetize
- (D) Define

56. A storyboard in Design Thinking is used to:

- (A) Record finances
- (B) List employees
- (C) Visualise a user's experience as a sequence of frames

(D) Replace prototyping entirely

57. Role-playing and bodystorming are techniques used to:

- (A) Audit accounts
- (B) Physically act out and empathise with experiences
- (C) Write code
- (D) Calculate taxes

58. 'Wizard of Oz' prototyping involves:

- (A) Humans simulating system functions behind the scenes
- (B) No users at all
- (C) Final production
- (D) A fully automated system

59. The primary benefit of testing with real users is to:

- (A) Increase development cost
- (B) Avoid iteration
- (C) Uncover flaws and gather actionable feedback
- (D) Confirm the team is always right

60. In Design Thinking, failure is viewed as:

- (A) Irrelevant
- (B) A reason to quit
- (C) Always unacceptable
- (D) A valuable source of learning

61. Multidisciplinary teams are valued in Design Thinking because they:

- (A) Bring varied perspectives and richer solutions
- (B) Slow everything down needlessly
- (C) Avoid collaboration
- (D) Reduce diversity of thought

62. Co-creation means involving _____ in the design process.

- (A) only engineers
- (B) only designers
- (C) only executives
- (D) users and stakeholders

63. 'How Might We' statements are deliberately phrased to be:

- (A) Optimistic and open to many solutions
- (B) Purely technical
- (C) Narrow and prescriptive
- (D) Negative

64. A prototype that looks and works close to the final product is called:

- (A) Low-fidelity
- (B) High-fidelity
- (C) Verbal
- (D) Paper-only

65. Rapid prototyping emphasises:

- (A) High upfront cost
- (B) Perfection before showing anyone
- (C) Avoiding users
- (D) Speed and quick feedback cycles

66. In ideation, 'building on the ideas of others' is captured by the phrase:

- (A) 'Maybe later'

- (B) 'Yes, and'
- (C) 'No, but'
- (D) 'Not now'

67. The phrase 'Yes, and' encourages participants to:

- (A) Accept and expand on contributions
- (B) Stay silent
- (C) Reject ideas
- (D) Compete

68. A key reason to defer judgment during ideation is to:

- (A) Avoid prototyping
- (B) Create psychological safety for wild ideas
- (C) Speed up firing
- (D) Reduce the number of ideas

69. Visualisation (sketching) in Design Thinking helps to:

- (A) Hide ideas
- (B) Increase confusion
- (C) Make abstract ideas tangible and shareable
- (D) Replace user research

70. Which factor does Design Thinking balance alongside human needs?

- (A) Technology and business viability
- (B) Only profit
- (C) Only aesthetics
- (D) Only regulations

71. The Empathize and Define stages together are often called the ____ space.

- (A) delivery
- (B) problem
- (C) production
- (D) solution

72. The Ideate, Prototype and Test stages are often called the ____ space.

- (A) solution
- (B) audit
- (C) problem
- (D) research

73. 'Point of View' (POV) typically combines a user, a need, and an:

- (A) Advertisement
- (B) Algorithm
- (C) Invoice
- (D) Insight

74. Which is a common pitfall in problem definition?

- (A) Keeping it human-centred
- (B) Framing it around the user
- (C) Being specific
- (D) Embedding a solution inside the problem statement

75. Prototyping helps reduce:

- (A) Empathy
- (B) User involvement
- (C) Risk and uncertainty before full investment
- (D) Creativity

76. The concept of 'wicked problems' refers to problems that are:

- (A) Already solved
- (B) Purely mathematical
- (C) Complex, ill-defined and interconnected
- (D) Simple and well-defined

77. Design Thinking is especially useful for tackling problems that are:

- (A) Ambiguous and human-centred
- (B) Purely numerical
- (C) Already fully understood
- (D) Routine and obvious

78. A 'value proposition' describes:

- (A) The benefit a solution offers to users
- (B) The office location
- (C) The number of employees
- (D) The company's tax rate

79. Empathy interviews should ideally make the interviewee feel:

- (A) Judged
- (B) Pressured to buy
- (C) Comfortable and free to share
- (D) Confused

80. The 'Five Whys' technique is used to:

- (A) Avoid analysis
- (B) Increase sales
- (C) Generate prototypes
- (D) Dig down to the root cause of a problem

81. Asking 'why' repeatedly during research helps uncover:

- (A) Financial reports
- (B) Surface-level facts only
- (C) Competitor pricing
- (D) Underlying motivations and root causes

82. A 'minimum viable product' (MVP) is built to:

- (A) Include every possible feature
- (B) Avoid user feedback
- (C) Test core assumptions with minimal effort
- (D) Maximise initial cost

83. In Design Thinking, constraints are viewed as:

- (A) Only obstacles
- (B) Reasons to stop
- (C) Drivers that can spark creativity
- (D) Irrelevant

84. The term 'ideation' is most closely linked to which stage?

- (A) Ideate
- (B) Test
- (C) Empathize
- (D) Define

85. Which is a divergent activity?

- (A) Final voting
- (B) Cutting the idea list

- (C) Selecting the final concept
- (D) Brainstorming many ideas

86. Which is a convergent activity?

- (A) Dot-voting to prioritise ideas
- (B) Generating variations
- (C) Brainstorming wildly
- (D) Free association

87. 'Dot voting' is a technique to:

- (A) Quickly prioritise options as a group
- (B) Generate ideas
- (C) Interview users
- (D) Build prototypes

88. Tim Brown describes Design Thinking as drawing on the designer's:

- (A) Sensibility and methods to match needs with feasibility
- (B) Sales quotas
- (C) Legal training
- (D) Accounting skills

89. Which of these best reflects a Design Thinking mindset?

- (A) Work alone in secret
- (B) Avoid feedback
- (C) Assume the solution first
- (D) Embrace ambiguity and stay curious

90. Prototyping 'to think' means using prototypes to:

- (A) Replace strategy
- (B) Avoid decisions
- (C) Skip empathy
- (D) Explore and refine ideas, not just demonstrate them

91. Which tool helps capture the emotional highs and lows of a user experience?

- (A) Gantt chart only
- (B) Balance sheet
- (C) Org chart
- (D) Journey map with an emotional curve

92. Reframing 'people don't use the stairs' as 'how might we make stairs fun' is an example of:

- (A) Convergent thinking
- (B) Cost cutting
- (C) Opportunity-focused problem reframing
- (D) Ignoring the user

93. Brainstorming sessions benefit from a clear:

- (A) Single approved idea
- (B) Focus question or 'How Might We' prompt
- (C) Ban on speaking
- (D) List of criticisms

94. In Design Thinking, the user's needs are discovered mainly through:

- (A) Assumptions
- (B) Random guessing
- (C) Sales targets
- (D) Empathy and research

95. Which is the best example of a high-fidelity prototype?

- (A) A napkin sketch
- (B) A single sticky note
- (C) A verbal description
- (D) An interactive clickable app mock-up

96. The overall spirit of Design Thinking can be summarised as:

- (A) Isolated and theoretical
- (B) Solution-first and rigid
- (C) Human-centred, collaborative and experimental
- (D) Profit-only and fixed

97. Prototyping and testing together help teams to:

- (A) Eliminate users
- (B) Skip empathy
- (C) Validate or invalidate assumptions before scaling
- (D) Avoid learning

98. A core question the Empathize stage tries to answer is:

- (A) What do users truly need and feel
- (B) Which competitor to copy
- (C) Who should we fire
- (D) How much profit will we make

99. Design Thinking is sometimes described as a balance of analytical thinking and:

- (A) Strict bureaucracy
- (B) Intuitive (creative) thinking
- (C) Random guessing
- (D) Financial auditing

100. Which deliverable best summarises the Define stage?

- (A) A marketing budget
- (B) A clear, actionable problem statement
- (C) A staffing plan
- (D) A finished product